

Diabetes and Heart Disease - AHA

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Diabetes Complications and Risks | American Heart Association

The effect diabetes has on the body happens slowly and can often progress without notice. Over time, having too much glucose (sugar) in the blood can damage a number of organs. These are often referred to as “complications” of diabetes. If you have been told you have prediabetes, you can take important healthy steps now to reduce your risk of developing a number of health problems: Heart and blood vessel damage Type 2 diabetes can increase your risk of developing complications, such as cardiovascular disease, atherosclerosis, stroke, peripheral artery disease and chronic kidney disease. Nerve damage Over time, high blood sugar levels can damage nerves, a condition called diabetic neuropathy. This can lead to numbness in the fingers, hands, toes and feet or tingling, burning, or shooting pains that usually begins at the fingers or toes and spread upwards. Symptoms of this nerve damage can also include vomiting, diarrhea, constipation, problems with sexual function, dizziness, and other symptoms. Kidney damage The kidneys filter about a half cup of blood every minute, removing wastes and extra fluid from your body. Over time, diabetes can damage your kidneys so they stop working effectively, requiring dialysis or a transplant. Dialysis is a procedure that removes waste products and excess fluid from the blood. Eye damage People with diabetes may have damage to the blood vessels and lenses in their eyes due to the high blood sugar levels. This can cause diseases such as glaucoma and cataracts and can lead to blindness. Foot damage Feet are also at risk of nerve and blood vessel damage from prolonged high blood sugar. This damage causes numbness, tingling, pain or a loss of feeling in the feet. Minor cuts and blisters can lead to ulcers, infections and amputations in serious cases. Skin and mouth conditions Diabetes may increase the risk of skin infections, mouth infections and gum disease. Osteoporosis People with Type

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